

401(k) FIDUCIARY PLAN DIAGNOSTIC

DEPARTMENT OF LABOR FORM 5500 COMPLIANCE & FEE AUDIT

Employer Sponsor:	Associated Consultants INC	Active Participants:	19
Plan Name:	Associated Consultants INC 401(k) Savings Plan	Fiduciary Assets:	\$4,651,315.00
Employer EIN:	440025034	Plan Administrator:	Sponsor Managed

Fiduciary Scorecard & Performance Indicators

Fiduciary Metric	Filing Value	Threshold Benchmark	Fiduciary Status
Plan Fee Ratio (bps)	0.69% (68 bps)	< 60 bps (0.60%)	SAFE / INSTITUTIONAL
Active Employee Participation	82.6%	> 70% Target	SAFE / TARGET MET
Corrective Compliance Refunds	\$0.00	\$0.00 (No Testing Failures)	SAFE / PASSED
Total Administrative Expenses	\$32,094.07	Value Validation Required	AUDIT INDICATOR

Fiduciary Risk Assessment & Key Recommendations

• **Fiduciary Oversight Safe:** All checked indicators reside within healthy guidelines. We recommend completing periodic vendor benchmarks every 3 years to maintain institutional pricing structures as plan assets expand.

Advisor Fiduciary Assessment Outreach Proposal

Subject: Fiduciary Health & Fee Diagnostic for Associated Consultants INC 401(k) Plan

Dear Plan Sponsor at Associated Consultants INC,

I recently conducted a comprehensive fiduciary health audit of the Department of Labor Form 5500 filings for the Associated Consultants INC 401(k) plan. Based on our analysis, we identified key opportunities to optimize your plan design, enhance participant returns, and insulate your committee from regulatory risk.

Specifically, our analysis flagged the following areas for immediate review:

- ****Excessive Plan Fees**:** Your plan administrative fee ratio is currently running at 0.69% (68 bps), which exceeds the 60 basis points industry threshold. As fiduciaries, plan sponsors are legally required to verify that recordkeeping, advisory, and administrative costs are reasonable. We can help execute a fee compression audit to reduce vendor drag and boost employee savings.

We would love to offer your committee a complimentary, side-by-side benchmarking report that details actionable steps to minimize fiduciary risk and elevate employee retirement success.

Are you open to a brief 15-minute call next Tuesday or Thursday to walk through our findings?

Best regards,
[Your Name]
[Your Fiduciary Advisory Firm]
[Contact Details]